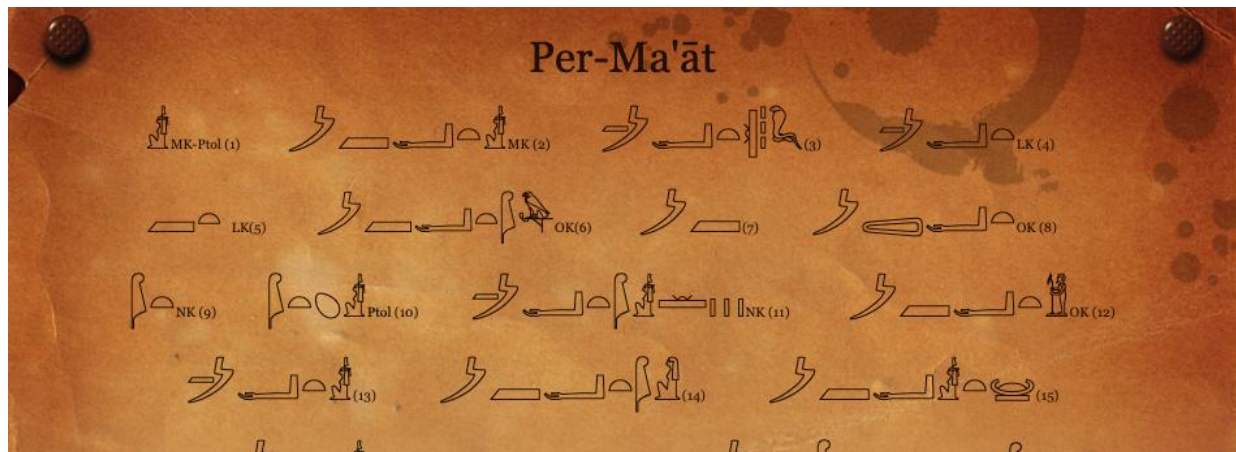


Egyptian Female Divinities

Hieroglyphs, Epithets & Lore — Reference for the Book Project

Compiled from seshkemet.weebly.com — hieroglyphs, epithets, name etymologies, iconography, familial relationships, cult centers, and invocations for each figure. Egyptian material only; Greek, Coptic, and Hebrew data excluded by design.

Ma'at (Maāt)



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs: (multiple period variants, see source)

MDC/Transliteration: mAat (Gardiner: m3't; Budge: Maāt)

Meaning: "She who is righteous" — mAat "righteous" + .t "she"

Home/Temple: Ipet-isut, Karnak

Family: Consort — Djehuty/Thoth; Father — Ra; Siblings — Shu (sometimes)

Priest names: Hm nTr mAat (Priest of Ma'at); sXAw-mAat (Scribe of Ma'at)

Features: A woman with an ostrich feather atop her head, holding the wAs scepter (power) and ankh (life)

Symbols: Ostrich feather; Vulture; The Plinth

Roles: Goddess of justice, truth, harmony. Weighs the heart (soul) on the scales against her feather of righteousness

Other forms: mAaty (dual form)

Epitaphs:

- di.n.i wn rA.k — "I have given a hand to open your mouth"
- dr-isft — "removes wrong-doers"
- dr-sbiw — "removes rebels"
- Hnt imntt / nbt dwAt — "Mistress of the Underworld"
- nbt pt — "Lady of heaven"
- sAt rA — "daughter of Rā"
- sDmt-sprw — "Hears petitions"
- sDmt-snmHw — "Hears prayers"

Invocation (Instruction of Ptahhotep): "Ma'at is good and its worth is lasting. It has not been disturbed since the day of its creator, whereas he who transgresses its ordinances is punished... a man can say: 'It was the property of my father.'"

Seshat



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs: / (7-pointed emblem / is her signature glyph)

MDC/Transliteration: sSt, sSA (Gardiner: ŠŠAt; Budge: Seshit)

Meaning: "Female scribe" — /sS/ "scribe" + /t/ "female"

Family: Consort — Djehuty/Thoth (sometimes); Children — Ma'āt (?); Parents — Rā, Djehuty (sometimes); Male counterpart — Seshu

Priest names: Hm-nTr-sSt "God's servant of Seshat"

Features: Dressed in Sem-priest attire (cheetah-hide dress), 7-pointed emblem over her head (possibly a palm frond with horns, tied to her New Kingdom name Sefkhet-Abwy, "she who wears the seven points")

Symbols: 7-pointed emblem; 7 horns; Shen symbol ; stars ; palm frond ; leopard/cheetah skin; books, scrolls, stylus

Roles: Goddess of writing, wisdom, architecture, astronomy, astrology, record-keeping, mathematics, surveying. Recorded royal reign-years via notches on a palm frond

Goddess in other forms: Sefkhet-Abwy (New Kingdom, "stretching the cord" ritual)

Connection to other gods: Nebet-Hut/Nephthys (helped ritually clean the limbs of the deceased); Min; mAfdt

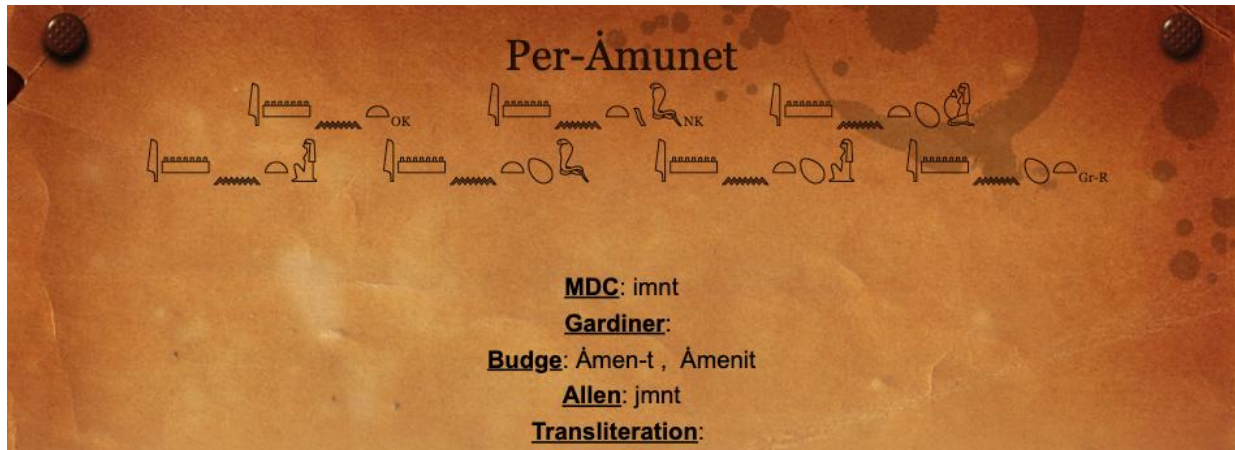
Celebrations: Sed festival (with Min); pedj shes "stretching the ritual cord"

Epitaphs:

- nbt pr mDA (t) — "mistress of the house of books"
- nbt sSt Hnwt pr mDA (t) — "Lady of writing, mistress of the house of books"
- nbt qd / nbt iqdw — "Lady of building(ers)"
- pD Ss — "stretching the cord or rope"
- sfxt-Abwy — "She of seven points/horns"
- She records the royal name of the nisut at birth; marks the king's term on the stem of her palm; helps mark a new temple's circumference in "stretching the cord"

Coffin Texts Spell 10: "Seshat opens the door of heaven for you"

Amunet (Āmunet)



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs: (OK) (later)

MDC/Transliteration: imnt

Meaning: "She who is hidden," the hidden one (female)

Home/Temple: Sky; Karnak in Thebes, Wetjeset-Hor at Edfu, Hibis

Nome: Primordial goddess of the Ogdoad (Xmnyw) of Hermopolis

Family: Consort — Amun (Thebes and Hermopolis, as his female aspect)

Features: Part of the Ogdoad, female form of Amun, part of the royal Sed-festival ceremonies; depicted as a woman wearing the Red Crown (Deshret) of Lower Egypt; snake goddess of elements; her shadow protects the gods

Symbols: Egyptian cobra; snakes; vulture; Red Crown Deshret

Roles: Protector of the King, goddess of air and invisibility/hidden forces; female counterpart of Amun; member of the Ogdoad

Hybrid gods: Neith-Amunet

Connection to other gods: Iusaaset (a shadow of Atum); Neith; Mut. *Note: not to be confused with the similarly-named goddess Amentet*

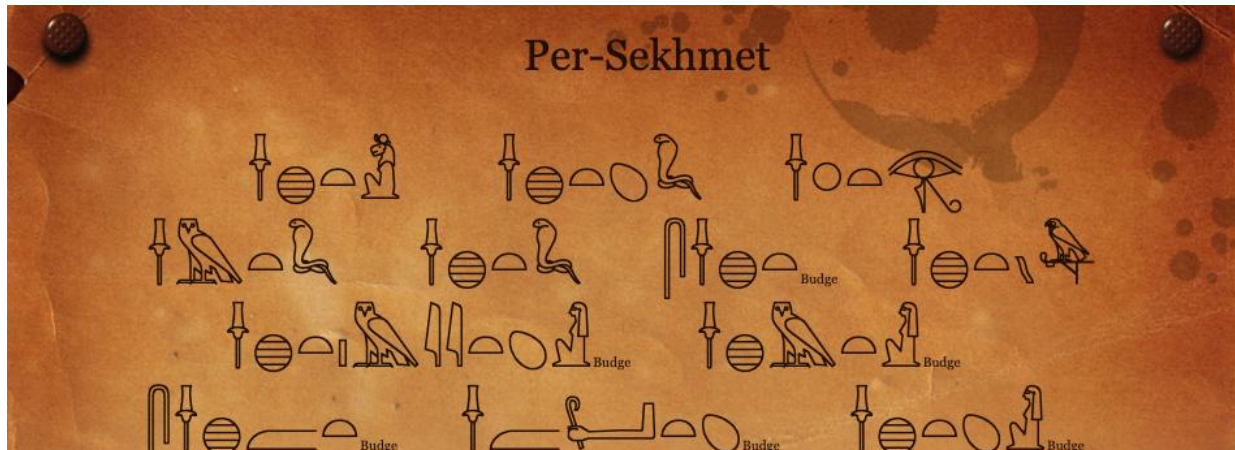
Celebrations: Ipet Festival, 19th day of Akhet II

Epitaphs:

- imnt aAt — "Amunet the great"
- imnt aAt wrt — "Amunet the very great"
- nbt pt — "The Lady of heaven"
- nbt nnt — "The Lady of Lower Heaven"
- mwt ra — "Mother of Ra"
- tmAt nt Sw — "The Mother of Sun Light"
- mwt-mwt — "Mother-Mother"

Invocation: "O Amun and Amunet! You pair of the gods, who joined the gods with their shadow."

Sekhmet



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs:

MDC/Transliteration: sxmt (Gardiner: Šḥmt)

Meaning: "She who is powerful" — sxm "power/mighty one" + .t "She"

Nome: 15th Upper Egypt (Taremu, "City of fish")

Family: Consort — Ptah; Children — Mai-hesa, Nefertem; Father — Rā; Siblings — Bastet

Priest names: wabw sxmt

Symbols: Fire; Sun; colors red, yellow, orange, maroon, burgundy

Roles: Goddess of flame, war, fertility, and healing

Names derived from her name: Sekhemt-Noufret ("Sekhmet is beautiful");

Sekhmet-merit-Ptah-heret ("Sekhmet beloved of Ptah in satisfaction")

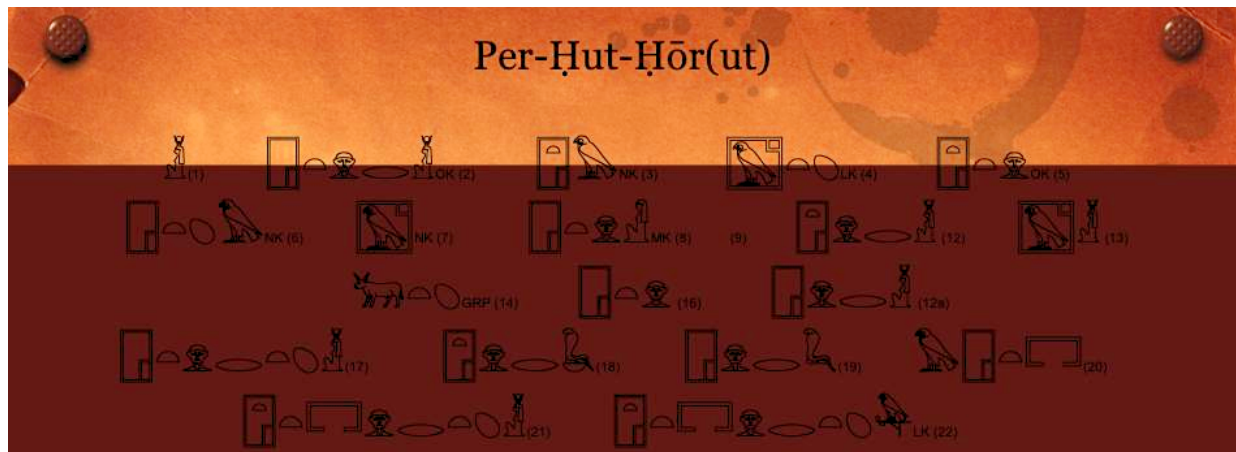
Epitaphs (grouped by theme in source):

- ***War/fear:*** nbt nrw "Lady of Terror"; nbt snDw "Lady of fear"; nbt xAyt "Lady of massacre"; wnm snfw "Eater of Blood"
- ***Justice:*** nbt mAat "Lady of Ma'at"; nTrt-aAt "Great goddess"
- ***Fire:*** aA nsrt "Great of flame"; nbt nsrt "Lady of Flame"; wnmyt "Devouring Flame"
- ***Gods:*** irt-ra "Eye of Ra"; aA mri ptH "Great, beloved of Ptah"
- ***Other:*** nbt aHAt "Lady of the palace"; nbt anx "Lady of life"; nbt tAwy "Lady of the two lands"; wrt HkAw "Great of Magic"; xnty pr-nsr "Foremost of the house of flame"

Invocation (original composition on source): *"inedj ḥer netjeret Sekhmet / nebet nesert / nebet unmyt / nebet em sekhem / nebet kheruyu — Hail to goddess Sekhmet, Lady of Flame, Lady of the Devouring Flame, Lady of power, Lady of war..."*

Edfu Temple inscription: "xp xriw wiA.sn mi nn smxt nw ra m sp-tpy m rn.T pfy n smt" — "When you encounter enemies in their barque, like those, you will prevail over the enemies of Ra in the First time in this your name of Sekhmet"

Het-Heru / Hathor (Ḥut-Ḥōr)



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs: (multiple period variants)

MDC/Transliteration: Hwt-Hr, Hwt-Hrt (Gardiner: ḥwt-ḥr)

Meaning: "Lady/House of Horu(s)" — /Hwt/ "House" + /Hr/ Horu/Horus. The variant Ḥut-Ḥuret means "Lady of the House above"

Home/Temple: Qebehu (Heaven); Iunet/Dendera ("Temple of healing"); Abu Simbel; Sinai

Nome: 6th & 22nd Upper, 14th Upper, 3rd Lower

Family: Consort — Ra-Horakhty, Horu-wer (Horus the Elder); Children — Ihy (son, with Horus), Amenetet (daughter, sometimes); Father — Ra; Mother — Nut

Priest names: bAtyt (devotee); HqA bAt (guardian of Hut-Hor); Hm.t-nTr-Hw.t (Priestess)

Features: A woman wearing a sun disk between cow horns; a cow; or human-cow hybrid; red hair (as the "7 Hathors")

Symbols: Cow; falcon; lioness; frog; milk; malachite; menit necklace ; sistrum ; turquoise; Sopdet/Sothis star; Wadjet Eye ; sycamore; papyrus; number 7

Roles: Goddess of the sky, love, sex, fertility, beauty, joy, music, dance, motherhood, healing, childbirth, foreign lands, and mining

Hybrid/other forms: Hesat (divine sky-cow, wife of Ra as the Mnevis Bull); Nebethotepet (associated with Atum); Bat (archaic cow goddess, possible earlier form)

"7 Hathors": Seven maidens (cow-form or horned-disk women) present at a child's birth to pronounce its fate

Celebrations offering items: Myrrh; malachite; gold; turquoise; sistrum; menit necklace; song, dance, music; papyrus; sycamore

Selected epitaphs:

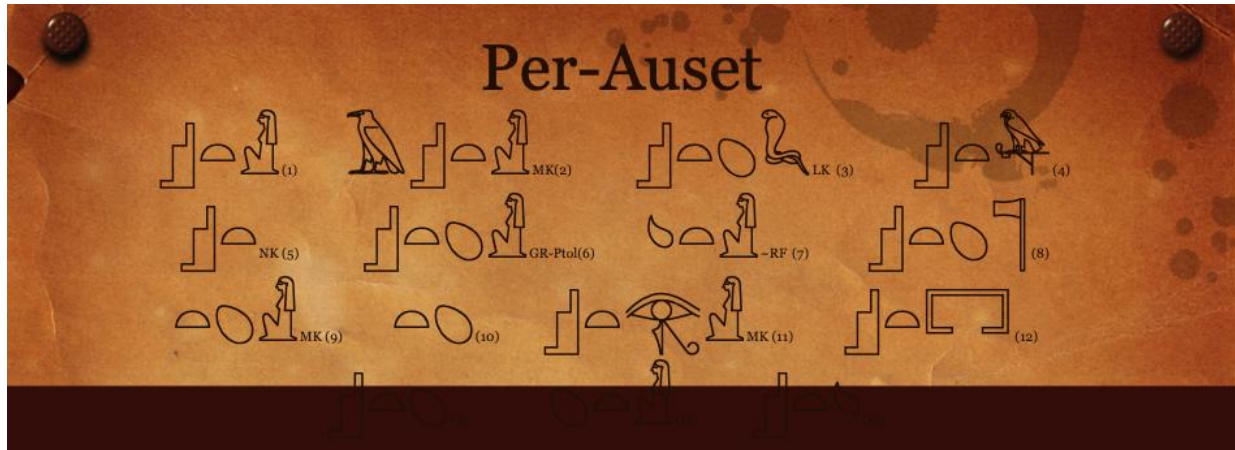
- nbt-Dr — "Lady of the Universe"
- nbt iwnt — "Lady of Dendera"
- nbt mfkAt — "Mistress of Turquoise"
- nbt pt — "Lady of heaven"
- sAt ra — "Daughter of Ra"
- sxmt — "She who is powerful"

- Drty — "two kites" (with Auset)
- HAY.ty — "the two mourners" (with Isis)
- nbt-ihy — "Lady of joy"
- nbt maHat — "Lady of the tomb"
- nbt pt — "Lady of the sky/heaven"

- nTr snt — "Divine sister"
- snt-wsir — "Sister to Osiris"
- wrt HkAw — "great of magic; mighty one of words of power"
- xArt — "Widow" (to Osiris)

Invocation (Book of the Dead, Spell 151): "I have encircled behind my brother Wesir/Osiris. I have come to be your protection. My protection is behind you, behind you, eternally..."

Auset / Isis



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs: (many period variants — Ast)

MDC/Transliteration: Ast (Gardiner: 3st; Budge: Åust)

Meaning: "Lady/She of the throne" — /As/ or /st/ "throne" + /t/ "female"

Home/Temple: pr Ast tA nTrt aAt ("temple of Isis great goddess"); "Mistress of the pyramid at Giza"; Philae/Pilak; Abydos; Iunu/Heliopolis

Nome: 12th & 13th Nome Lower Egypt; 7th Nome Diospolis Parva

Birthday: mswt Ast Hb

Family: Consort — Wesir/Osiris; Children — Horu/Horus, Anpu/Anubis (adopted); Father — Geb; Mother — Nut; Siblings — Osiris, Set, Nephthys, Horu-wer

Priest names: Hm-nTr n Ast (Prophet of Auset); wab n Ast; msniw/msnti ("spinners")

Features: A woman with a throne on her head, or the solar disk with cow horns; sometimes winged

Symbols: Throne; Tyet/Tit (Knot of Isis) ; cow horns; goose; kite bird (Dryt); scorpion; sparrow; swallow; Shen ring ; cobra; sistrum; sycamore/acacia

Roles: Goddess of health, marriage, domestic life, womanhood, fertility, purification, weaving/spinning, nature, magic, family, wisdom; friend to slaves, sinners, artisans, the downtrodden; mother of the King through Horus

Celebrations: II. Akhet 4

Other names: Nebet Heka ("Lady of magic"); Shonti (with Nephthys); TAyt; Weret Heka ("great of magic")

Selected epitaphs:

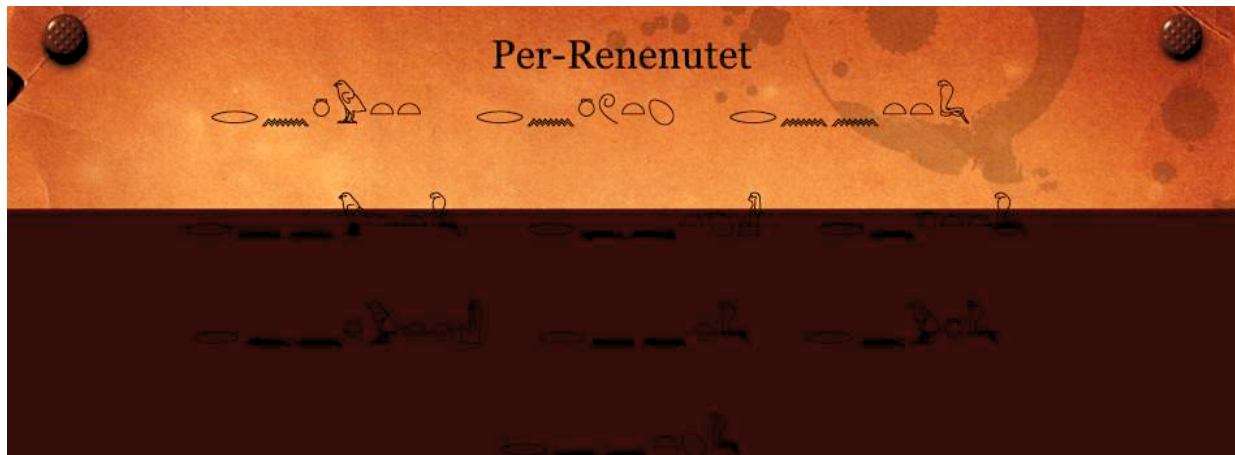
- Ast wrt HkAw — "Isis great in words of power/Magic"

- Ast wrt nTrt mwt — "Isis great divine mother"
- Hnwt-nTrw-nbw — "mistress of all gods"
- mwt Hrw — "mother of Horus"
- mwt-nTr — "god's mother"
- nbt pt — "Lady of heaven"
- wrt-HqAwt — "Great lady of magic"

Invocation ("Prayer to Isis"): *"nehesi, nehesi, nehesi / nehesi em ḥotep / nebet em neferu — Awake, Awake, Awake, Awake in peace, Lady of goodness."*

From "Isis and the Name of Ra": "Dd.in ist n ra / i.Dd n.i rn.k it.i nTr — Then said Isis to Ra: 'Tell me your name, my divine father. A man lives when called by his name.'"

Renenutet



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs:

MDC/Transliteration: rnnwt(t)

Meaning: "She who belongs to the name," "She who rejoices" (/rnnwt/), or "She who brings up/nurses" (/rnn/ "beget" + /wtt/)

Home/Temple: The Delta; Terenuthis/Tarrana, Kom Abu Billo (Lower Egypt); Dja/Medinet Madi (Fayoum/Narmouthis); Abydos; Thebes; Giza

Family: Consort — Sobek (sometimes), Geb (parent of Nehebkau), Shai (as goddess of fortune); Children — Nehebkau, a form of Horus

Features: A woman with a cobra's head, or a full-bodied cobra with feathers and sometimes a solar disk; sometimes lion-form

Symbols: Cobra; lion; wine press; mummy wrappings; Shen symbol

Roles: Goddess of nourishment, the harvest, nursing/rearing children, protection of the Pharaoh in the Duat, and the 9th month. Powerful in the underworld — destroys enemies with her gaze or fiery breath. Thought to give a child their true name (rn); linked to fortune since a destroyed name/statue meant destruction of the person

Connection to other gods: Wadjet; Renenet (possibly the same goddess); Auset/Isis (through the mother role to Horus); Nepri (grain goddess); Hapi; Ma'at

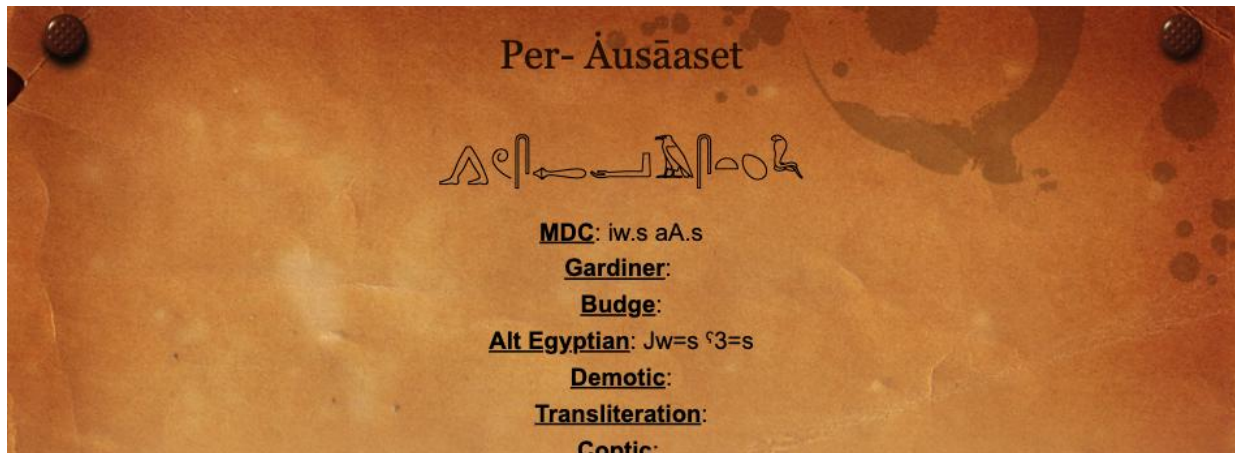
Celebrations: Shemu harvest season; annual festival at Dja/Medinet Madi for the best crops

Epitaphs:

- wrt-hkAw — "Great of magic"
- "Nourishing snake"
- "Lady of Robes" (Ptolemaic)
- "Lady of Fertile Fields"
- "Lady of Granaries"

Hymn of Renenutet: "I will make the Nile swell for you, without there being a year of lack and exhaustion in the whole land, so the plants will flourish, bending under their fruit..."

Iusaaset (Ausaaset / Iusaas)



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs:

MDC/Transliteration: iw.s aA.s

Meaning: "She who grows as she comes" — /iw/ "come" + /.s/ "she" + /aA/ "large/huge" + /.s/ "she"

Temple: Worshipped in Iunu/Heliopolis

Family: Consort — Tem/Atum (married to her at Heliopolis); Female counterpart of Atum

Features: A woman with a scarab on her head

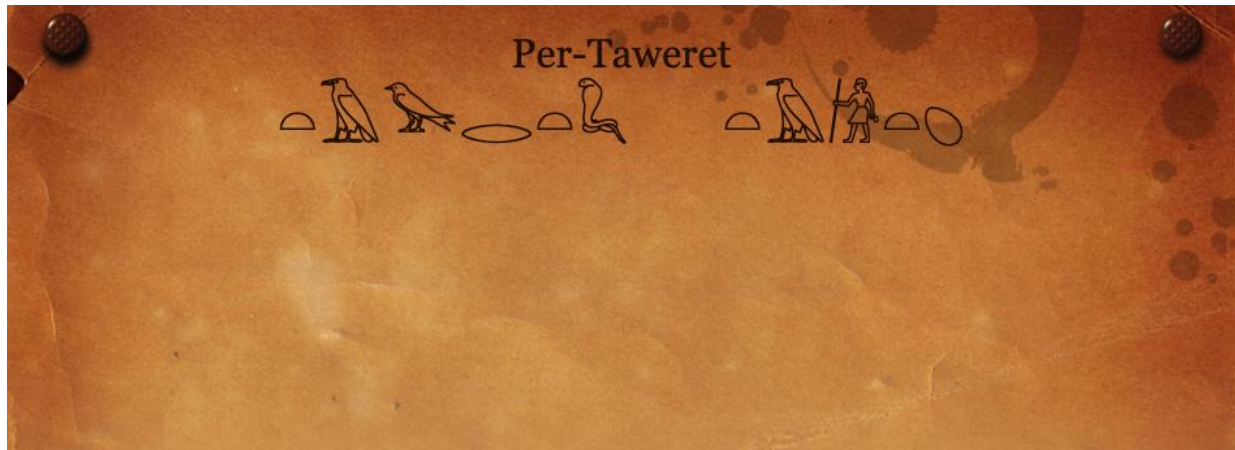
Symbols: Acacia tree

Roles: Primal goddess, "grandmother of all the gods." Personifies the "hand of god" with which Atum created the world from himself; alternate tradition says she emerged from the crown of Geb. Egyptologist Stephen Quirke suggests she and Nebethetepet represented two aspects of creation (growth vs. abundance)

Connection to other gods: Hut-Hor/Hathor; Nebethetepet ("Lady of the Offerings" — considered the same goddess in early texts, separated after the Middle Kingdom)

Epitaphs: "Iusaaset at Heliopolis"

Taweret



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs:

MDC/Transliteration: tAwrt (Gardiner: T3-wrt)

Meaning: "She who is great"

Cult: Worshipped throughout Egypt; also adopted into Levantine, Minoan, and Nubian (Kerma) royal ritual

Family: Consort — Setesh/Set (sometimes), Bes; Children — Amun-Ra (Ptolemaic tradition); Father — Ra; Mother — Auset/Isis or Wesir/Osiris (uncertain)

Features: Bipedal hippopotamus with exposed human breasts, feline hands/feet, and a crocodile tail/back, often carrying the sA protection symbol

Symbols: sA symbol ; hippopotamus; the right Wadjet Eye of Ra; the Northern sky

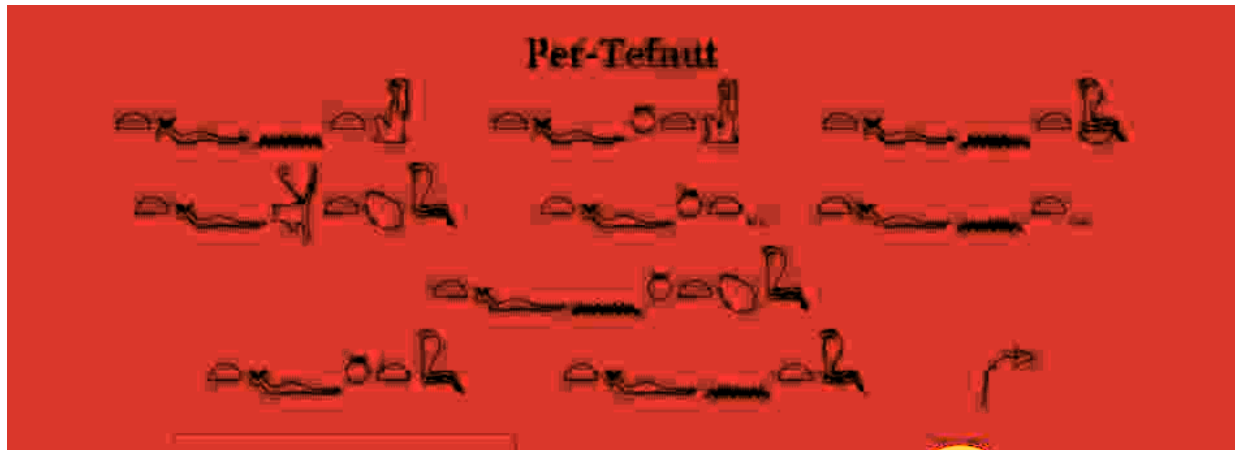
Roles: Goddess of fertility, women, childbirth, child-rearing, and the home; fearsome protector; her amulets were worn by pregnant women; considered a demon in later periods

Connection to other gods: Other hippo deities — Ipet (the nurse), Reret (the sow), Hedjet (the white one); Hut-Hor; Auset; Ipy/Opet/Apet (earlier hippo goddess merged into Taweret)

Epitaphs:

- nbt m pt — "Lady of heaven"
 - rrt — "sow"
 - sAt-ra — "daughter of Rā"
 - "Mistress of the horizon"
 - "She who removes waters"
 - "Mistress of pure water"
 - "Lady of the birthing house"
-

Tefnut



Hieroglyphic name-block (source: seshkemet.weebly.com)

Hieroglyphs:

MDC/Transliteration: tfnt, tfnwt

Meaning: Possibly "She of water" (/tf/ "that" (f) + /nw/ "water" + /t/ female ending); alt: "to spit" (/tf.n/ or /tfi/); alt: "orphan" (/tfn/)

Temple: Iunu/Heliopolis ("City of pillars"); Taremu/Leontopolis ("City of the lions")

Family: Father — Ra/Atum; Mother — Iusaaset; Siblings — Shu, Hut-Hor, Ma'at

Features: Lion-headed woman with pointed ears, uraeus headdress, sometimes with solar disk

Symbols: Lion; green/blue colors; water; serpents

Roles: Goddess of rain, air, moisture, weather, dew, lions, fertility, and water. Atum created her and her twin brother Shu either by masturbation, or by spitting/sneezing them out

Other names: HA(i)t; Dt/Djet (Middle Kingdom)

Epitaphs:

- Dt — "Forever" (fixed, unchanging, eternal sameness)
- mHyt nfrt — "Beautiful north wind"
- tfn — "orphan"
- "10th God of the Nine from Heliopolis"

Pyramid Texts: "Atum said: Tefnut is my living daughter, she is together with her brother Shu. 'Life' is his name, 'truth' is her name... 'life' sleeps with my daughter 'truth'."
